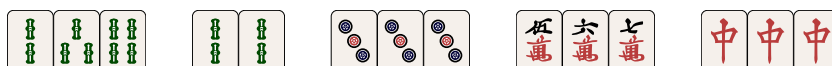


1 Game Basics

The goal of Riichi Mahjong is to earn more points than the other players by winning hands. To win a hand you must build a valid hand of 14 tiles before any of your opponents, then the quality of your hand will determine how many points you win.

1.1 What is a Valid Hand

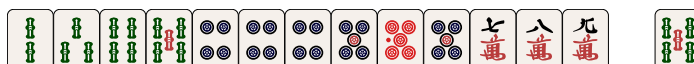
A valid hand is made of 5 shapes, 4 sets of 3 tiles and 1 pair. Each set of 3 tiles can either be a consecutive sequence of tiles in the same suit or a set of 3 identical tiles. E.g.



A hand must also contain a Yaku to be valid.

1.2 Making a Hand

During the game your hand will consist of 13 tiles, and each turn you will draw one tile and discard one tile. The goal is to reach a point where the 13 tiles in your hand only need one more tile to be a valid hand. Being one tile away from a valid hand is called being in Tenpai (or Ready Hand). An example is below, with the 14th tile being one of the tiles needed to complete the hand.



1.3 Calling Tiles

Drawing and discarding isn't the only way to add tiles to your hand. When other players discard tiles there are three different calls you can make to add the discarded tile to your hand. Once you have made a call your hand is considered open (e.g. you cannot call Riichi). The general steps are:

1. A player discards a tile that completes a sequence or set that is partially complete in your hand.
2. Make the corresponding call and take the discarded tile, placing it and the tiles from your hand that complete the set face up next to your hand.

3. Discard a tile from your hand. You cannot discard a tile that would have completed the shape instead of the tile you took, e.g. you cannot discard  if you took the  to complete the   set.
4. The player after you in turn order takes their turn. (This can cause a player to miss a turn.)

1.3.1 Chii

Chii is a call you can make only when the player before you in turn order discards a tile you can use to complete a sequence. For example, if you had   in your hand, and the player before you discards the  you can call Chii.

1.3.2 Pon

Pon is a call you can make when any other player discards a tile that completes a set of 3 tiles. If you have   in your hand you could call Pon for the third .

1.3.3 Kan

Kan is the trickiest call as it has some extra rules. Firstly Kan calls create groups of 4 tiles, these function as groups of 3 for anything that requires a group of 3, but only groups of 4 can count toward things that specify groups of 4. It also means your final hand will have more than 14 tiles, because one or more of the shapes will be 4 tiles. There are 3 types of Kan call,

- Daminkan (Open Kan): This is called like Pon, only if you have three of a tile in your hand, you call Kan when another player discards the fourth.
- Ankan (Closed Kan): You can call this Kan if you have 4 of a tile in your hand. Calling Kan in this way does not count as opening your hand, and when you place the tiles next to your hand place them such as



- Shouminkan (Added Kan): If you have previously called Pon to create a group of three tiles, and draw the fourth tile of the group you can call Kan and add it to the group of three.

All Kan calls also have two extra rules. After you call, you draw an extra tile from the Dead Wall before you discard a tile. Finally after a Kan is completed another tile in the Dead Wall is revealed to be a new Dora Indicator.

1.4 Winning

Once your hand is in Tenpai (it only needs one more tile to be a valid hand), there are two calls you can make to win the hand.

1.4.1 Ron

Ron is called when another player discards the tile you need to win. In this case the point value of your hand is deducted from their point total and added to your total.

1.4.2 Tsumo

Tsumo is called when you draw the tile you need to win. In this case the point value of the hand is split and paid by all the other players into your total.

1.5 Riichi

Riichi Mahjong has a special call you can make called Riichi. If your hand is closed (you haven't called Chii, Pon or Kan) and it is in Tenpai, you can call Riichi when you discard your tile for the turn. When you discard it turn the tile sideways to indicate the moment when you called Riichi. After calling Riichi, you cannot change the contents of your hand, on your turn you only draw a tile and discard it until you can call Ron or Tsumo.

2 Non-Yaku Han Scorers

These are features of a hand that provide Han, but do not count as Yaku and themselves cannot make a hand valid.

2.1 Dora: 1 Han

At the start of the game one of the tiles on the Dead Wall is revealed as a Dora Indicator. The dora indicators look like,



Whichever tile comes after the Dora Indicator is a Dora tile, so in the above example  would be a Dora tile. The sequence loops so if  is the Dora Indicator then  is a Dora tile.

The Honor tiles also have an order, the Wind tiles are in the order of play    . Similarly the Dragon tiles have an order   , but you can remember the sequence alphabetically, green to red to white.

2.2 Kandora: 1 Han

After a player calls Kan, the next tile of the Dead Wall is flipped and becomes another Dora indicator. Continuing from the example above the wall might now show



Which means that  and  are both Dora tiles.

2.3 Akadora: 1 Han

In Riichi Mahjong there are often a set of red 5s. Some sets have one in each suit, and some have one in each except two in the circle suit. These tiles look like .

2.4 Uradora: 1 Han

If you win a hand after calling Riichi the tiles under the the currently revealed Dora Indicators are revealed as Uradora Indicators. E.g. if the dora indicators looked like



and you won by Riichi, it might reveal



as the Uradora Indicators. Meaning that , ,  and  all give 1 Han.

2.5 Stacking Dora

One tile can be a Dora tile multiple times, and thus be worth multiple Han. For example, if the Dora Indicators showed



then  would be worth 2 Han. Similarly if the Dora Indicator was



then  would be worth 2 Han.

3 Yaku

Yaku are features of a hand that provide Han. Importantly a hand needs to have a Yaku in order to be able to win in Riichi Mahjong.

3.1 Riichi: 1 Han (Closed Hand Only)

A closed hand in Tenpai can call Riichi, typically the first discard made after calling Riichi is turned sideways. Once in Riichi you cannot change your hand, only drawing a tile and discarding it if it doesn't complete the hand.

3.2 Double Riichi: 2 Han (Closed Hand Only)

A Riichi called on the first turn is a Double Riichi.

3.3 Ippatsu: 1 Han (Conditional)

If after calling Riichi you win before your next discard you have this Yaku. Any player making a call (Chii, Pon, Kan) invalidates this Yaku.

3.4 Iipeikou: 1 Han (Closed Hand Only)

Pure Double Sequence. Two sequences that are exactly the same, e.g.



if you sort your hand in ascending order this often looks like



3.5 Ryanpeikou: 3 Han (Closed Hand Only)

Twice Pure Double Sequence. Two Iepeikou that don't have to be the same, e.g.



3.6 Yakuhai Prevalent Wind: 1 Han

Having a set of 3 of the wind tile that corresponds to the prevalent wind (sometimes called round wind), counts as this Yaku. For example in an east round the following hand has Yakuhai Prevalent Wind:



3.7 Yakuhai Seat Wind: 1 Han

Having a set of 3 of the wind tile that corresponds to your seat position gives this Yaku. If you were in the northern seat then the following hand has Yakuhai Seat Wind:



3.8 Yakuhai Dragons: 1 Han

Having a set of three of a dragon gives this yaku. For example the following has Yakuhai Red Dragon:



3.9 Shousangen: 2 Han

Little Three Dragons. Two sets and a pair of the dragons. E.g.



3.10 Daisangen: Yakuman

Big Three Dragons. Three sets of the dragons. E.g.



3.11 Shousuushi: Yakuman

Little Four Winds. Three sets of winds with a pair of the fourth. E.g.



3.12 Daisuushi: Double Yakuman

Big Four Winds. A set of each wind tile. E.g.



3.13 Tanyao: 1 Han

All Simples. A hand without any terminal tiles (1 and 9) or honor tiles (winds and dragons). E.g.